

Work-Life Balance

Work and Time

加班 — overtime: extra hours after your workday ends
通勤 — commute: the trip between home and your office
年假 — paid vacation days: days off that you still get paid for
弹性工时 — flexible hours: choosing when you start and stop
居家办公 — working from home: doing your job from your own place
大小周 — alternating weeks: five days one week, six the next
轮班 — shift work: working nights or weekends in turns
打卡 — clock in and out: recording when you start and leave
下班时间 — quitting time: the hour your workday officially ends
工作与生活平衡 — work-life balance: time for both your job and your life

When Balance Breaks

倦怠 — burnout: feeling empty and tired from months of stress
随时待命 — always on call: expected to answer at any hour
下班后消息 — after-hours messages: work texts that arrive at night
过劳 — overwork: working far more than your body can take
内卷 — rat race: a race to keep up that nobody can win
睡眠不足 — sleep debt: the sleep you keep missing
周末加班 — working weekends: losing your Saturday to the office
无法下线 — can't switch off: your mind stays at work after hours
工作焦虑 — work anxiety: worry about work that will not stop

Setting Boundaries

划清界限 — set boundaries: decide what work cannot take from you
下班断联 — unplug: stop checking work messages after hours
拒绝额外工作 — turn down extra work: say no to one more task
优先排序 — prioritize: decide what really comes first
委派 — delegate: hand part of the work to someone else
保护时间 — protect your time: keep some hours for yourself
准时下班 — leave on time: walk out when your hours are done
好好休息 — take a real break: rest with no phone and no laptop
静音通知 — mute notifications: stop the pings after work
预留缓冲 — block time: keep some empty hours in your day

Warm-up Discussion

How many hours do you work in a normal week, overtime included?

How much time do you have for yourself on a workday?

How many vacation days do you get a year, and did you use them all last year?

How long is your commute, and what do you do on the way?

What helps you unwind after a long day at work?

Discussion

Some companies work alternating weeks — five days one week, six the next. Could you work that schedule, and what would you ask for in return?

When you work from home, when does your workday really end, and what did your last work-from-home day look like?

Would you rather take one long vacation or several short ones, and why?

Is your commute your own time or wasted time, and what would make it better?

A coworker asks you to cover their weekend shift for the third time. How do you say no and keep the friendship?

Your phone buzzes with work messages all weekend. What do you do to keep the weekend yours?

If your job and your family both need you next Saturday, how do you decide?

If you could design your perfect workday — start time, breaks, quitting time — what would it look like?

Have smartphones and laptops made your work-life balance better or worse, and what is one example from your own week?